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Optoelectronic device having a modular package

Abstract

A segmented optoelectronic semiconductor package may help to alleviate stresses resulting from bending that can cause a mechanical defect (e.g., crack) in a detector circuit. The bending can result from thermal growth/shrinkage of parts used in the optical electronic package and may be more pronounced for high aspect ratio detector circuits. The segmentation of the disclosed semiconductor package can create seams that allow the parts to flex without breaking. As a result, the disclosed semiconductor package may facilitate high aspect ratio optical detection over a wide temperature range.

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Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

(1) The present disclosure relates to circuit packaging and more specifically, to an optoelectronic package having a modular aspect to accommodate flexing.

BACKGROUND

(2) A single-photon avalanche diode (SPAD) can be configured to detect light with a very high sensitivity. For example, a SPAD may be sensitive to light in a range of 1 to 1000 photons. A silicon photomultiplier (SiPM) can include an array of SPADS on a silicon substrate as pixels to help increase a field-of-view of the detection.

SUMMARY

(3) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optoelectronic package including: a circuit substrate having a longer dimension aligned with a long axis and a shorter dimension aligned with a short axis; and a carrier fixedly coupled (e.g., soldered) to the circuit substrate, the carrier including a plurality of substrate modules arranged in a sequence aligned with the long axis, wherein seams are formed between adjacent pairs of substrate modules in the sequence so that, in response to the circuit substrate being curved along the long axis, the carrier flexes.

(4) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optoelectronic package, wherein: the substrate modules are a ceramic material having a first coefficient of thermal expansion (i.e., CTE) and the circuit substrate is a glass-reinforced epoxy laminate material having a second coefficient of thermal expansion; and the circuit substrate is curved along the long axis due to a difference between the first coefficient of thermal expansion and the second coefficient of thermal expansion during a thermal cycle.

(5) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optoelectronic package, wherein the thermal cycle is in a range from -55 degrees Celsius to $+150$ degrees Celsius.

(6) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optoelectronic package, wherein an aspect ratio of the longer dimension to the shorter dimension is greater than or equal to 2 to 1 (e.g., 4 to 1).

(7) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optoelectronic package, further including: a silicon photomultiplier including a plurality of pixel array circuits bonded to the carrier in a sequence that is staggered with respect to a direction aligned with the long axis.

(8) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optoelectronic package, wherein: adjacent pairs of the plurality of pixel array circuits are separated by a gap in a direction aligned with the short axis and overlap by an overlap in the direction aligned with the long axis.

(9) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optoelectronic package, wherein the silicon photomultiplier includes at least two pixel array circuits in the sequence.

(10) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optoelectronic package, wherein each of the plurality of substrate modules has a top surface configured to support at least one of the plurality of pixel array circuits, the top surface including a first rectangular portion and a second rectangular portion, the first rectangular portion joined to the second rectangular portion along a length of a side.

(11) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optoelectronic package, wherein a first pixel array circuit of a pair of pixel array circuits is bonded to the first rectangular portion and a second pixel array circuit of the pair of pixel array circuits is bonded to the second rectangular portion.

(12) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optoelectronic package, wherein each of the plurality of substrate modules has a first edge configured to couple to a previous substrate module in the sequence and a second edge configured to couple with a subsequent substrate module in the sequence, the first edge having a first key feature and the second edge having a second key feature, the first key feature and the second key feature having teeth, the teeth configured to interlock when brought together at a seam.

(13) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a silicon photomultiplier including: a circuit substrate having a longer dimension and a shorter dimension aligned within a plane; a carrier fixedly coupled to the circuit substrate, the carrier including a plurality of substrate modules arranged in a sequence aligned with the longer dimension wherein seams are formed between adjacent pairs of substrate modules in the sequence so that, in response to the circuit substrate being deflected from the plane, the carrier flexes; a window including a plurality of glass lids that bonded to sidewalls of the carrier in a sequence, wherein glass seams are formed between adjacent pairs of glass lids in the sequence; and a plurality of pixel array circuits bonded to the carrier in a sequence that is staggered with respect to a direction aligned with the longer dimension, the silicon photomultiplier configured to detect light through the window.

(14) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a silicon photomultiplier, wherein the light is a LIDAR signal.

(15) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a silicon photomultiplier, wherein: the substrate modules are a ceramic material having a first coefficient of thermal expansion and the circuit substrate is a glass-reinforced epoxy laminate material having a second coefficient of thermal expansion; and the circuit substrate is deflected from the plane due to a difference between the first coefficient of thermal expansion and the second coefficient of thermal expansion during a thermal cycle.

(16) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a silicon photomultiplier, wherein the thermal cycle is in a range from -55 degrees Celsius to $+150$ degrees Celsius.

(17) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a silicon photomultiplier, wherein an aspect ratio of the longer dimension to the shorter dimension is greater than or equal to 2 to 1 (e.g., 4 to 1).

(18) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a silicon photomultiplier, wherein: adjacent pairs of the plurality of pixel array circuits are separated by a gap in a direction aligned with the shorter dimension and overlap by an overlap in the direction aligned with the longer dimension.

(19) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a silicon photomultiplier, wherein the silicon photomultiplier includes at least two pixel array circuits in the sequence.

(20) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a silicon photomultiplier, wherein: each of the plurality of substrate modules has a top surface that includes a first rectangular portion and a second rectangular portion, the first rectangular portion joined to the second rectangular portion along a length of a side; and a first pixel array circuit of a pair of pixel array circuits is bonded to the first rectangular portion and a second pixel array circuit of the pair of pixel array circuits is bonded to the second rectangular portion.

(21) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a silicon photomultiplier, wherein each of the plurality of substrate modules has a first edge configured to couple to a previous substrate module in the sequence and a second edge configured to couple with a subsequent substrate module in the sequence, the first edge having a first key feature and the second edge having a second key feature, the first key feature and the second key feature having teeth

configured to interlock when brought together at a seam.

(22) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optical receiver including: an optical assembly configured to focus light from a field of view; and a silicon photomultiplier including: a printed circuit board having a longer dimension aligned with a long axis and a shorter dimension aligned with a short axis; a carrier soldered to the printed circuit board, the carrier including a plurality of substrate modules arranged in a sequence aligned with the long axis wherein seams are formed between adjacent pairs of substrate modules in the sequence so that the carrier can flex as the printed circuit board is curved along the long axis; a window including a plurality of glass lids that bonded to sidewalls of the carrier in a sequence, wherein glass seams are formed between adjacent pairs of glass lids in the sequence; and a plurality of pixel array circuits bonded to the carrier in a sequence that is staggered with respect to a direction aligned with the long axis, the silicon photomultiplier configured to detect the light from the field of view through the window.

(23) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an optical receiver, wherein the glass seams of the window do not overlap with the seams of the carrier.

(24) The foregoing illustrative summary, as well as other exemplary objectives and/or advantages of the disclosure, and the manner in which the same are accomplished, are further explained within the following detailed description and its accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a top view of a pixel array circuit according to an implementation of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 is a side view of a photomultiplier according to a possible implementation of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 3 is a top view of a substrate module according to an implementation of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 4 is a top view of a carrier including pixel array circuits according to an implementation of the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 5 is a top view of a plurality of pixel array circuits in a sequence that is staggered according to an implementation of the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 6A is a top view of a carrier including a plurality of substrate modules according to an implementation of the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 6B is a side view of the carrier including a glass lid according to an implementation of the present disclosure.

(8) FIG. 7 is a top view of a carrier including a seam between edges that includes a key feature according to an implementation of the present disclosure.

(9) FIG. 8 is a block diagram of an optical receiver according to an implementation of the present disclosure.

(10) The components in the drawings are not necessarily to scale relative to each other. Like reference numerals designate corresponding parts throughout the several views.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(11) A semiconductor photomultiplier (i.e., photomultiplier) may have a detection sensitivity that is suitable for detecting backscattered light at very low intensities. Accordingly, the photomultiplier may be used in an optical receiver for a vehicle LIDAR system to help with crash avoidance and/or navigation. In these implementations, a larger field-of-view may be desired, but the larger field-of-view may require a larger (e.g., longer) photomultiplier, which can create durability problems when operated in a harsh environment, such as in a vehicle (e.g., car, truck, etc.).

(12) Optoelectronics for a vehicle may be required to operate reliably over a thermal cycle in a range from -55 degrees Celsius to +150 degrees Celsius. Coefficients of thermal expansion (i.e., CTEs) of materials used in the photomultiplier may cause flexing or forces that can damage (e.g., crack) some components when cycled over this range. The likelihood of cracking can become more pronounced as a size (e.g., aspect ratio) of the photomultiplier is increased. Thus, reliable operation of a larger (i.e., longer) photomultiplier over a temperature range may pose a technical problem.

(13) The present disclosure describes an optoelectronic package that can address this technical problem. The disclosed optoelectronic package includes features that provide a mechanical stress relief. The stress relief can reduce or eliminate cracks due to the flexing (i.e., bowing) of long, narrow (i.e., high-aspect ratio) optoelectronic circuits. The disclosed optoelectronic package may therefore improve a durability of the optoelectronic circuits, which may be useful in harsh environments, such as those where operating over a large temperature range is required. For example, the disclosed optoelectronic package may support a photomultiplier having a long array of pixels configured to detect light.

(14) FIG. 1 is a top view of a pixel array circuit according to an implementation of the present disclosure. The pixel array circuit **100** may include a die **120** on which an array of pixels is fabricated. The die may be a semiconductor material, such as silicon (Si), germanium (Ge) or a III-V combination of materials. For the purposes of this disclosure, a Si die will be assumed. Each pixel **110a-h** may be a single-photon avalanche diode (i.e., SPAD). The pixels may be arranged in an array (i.e., sequence) that is linear and that has a length that is determined based on a system requirement, with some possible lengths being 8, 12, and 16 pixels. Pixels of the pixel array circuit **100** may be square or rectangular and may have a size that is less than or equal to 2 millimeters (mm) (e.g., 1 mm×1 mm). In a possible implementation, a first pixel **110a** and a last pixel **110h** may have a larger width than other pixels in the array to compensate for an overlap, which will be discussed below. The die **120** may further include bond pads to which wires **130** may be bonded in order to provide an electrical connection between the pixel array circuit **100** and other electronics. The pixel array circuit **100** may have an aspect ratio defined in terms of columns of pixels versus rows of pixels, which is 8 to 1 for the implementation shown in FIG. 1.

(15) FIG. 2 is a side view of a photomultiplier according to an implementation of the present disclosure. The photomultiplier **200** includes a pixel array circuit **100** that is bonded to a carrier substrate (i.e., carrier, substrate, etc.). The bond material may be an epoxy applied in an automated pick-and-place process. The pixel array circuit **100** may be electrically connected (e.g., wire bonded) to the carrier **210**, which in turn can be electrically connected to a circuit substrate. In a possible implementation, the circuit substrate is a printed circuit board (i.e., PCB **220**). The PCB **220** can be fixedly coupled to the carrier **210** by soldering. For example, the PCB can be soldered to the carrier **210** with a plurality of solder balls **215** in order to fixedly couple the PCB **220** and the carrier **210**. For example, the solder balls **215** may be part of a ball grid array connection between the PCB **220** and the carrier **210**. In a possible implementation, the solder balls are less than 300 microns in diameter (e.g., 250 microns).

(16) The carrier **210** may be a ceramic material (e.g., sintered ceramic) or a molded material (e.g., injected molded polymer, molded epoxy, etc.). While the disclosure is not limited to a ceramic carrier (i.e., package), a ceramic carrier will be discussed because it includes thermal properties that may be desirable for some applications. These thermal properties can include its ability to efficiently propagate heat away from the silicon and its low thermal expansion rate (i.e., first coefficient of thermal expansion (CTE)). For example, the ceramic may change a dimension with temperature at a rate that is 5 parts per million per degree Celsius (i.e., first CTE=5 ppm/° C.).

(17) The PCB **220** can be a glass-reinforced epoxy laminate material common to electronics, such as FR4. The PCB **220** may have a different thermal expansion rate (i.e., second CTE) than the ceramic in response to a temperature change. For example, the PCB **220** may change dimension with temperature at a rate that is 30 parts per million per degree Celsius (i.e., second CTE=30 ppm/

° C.). The difference between the first CTE of the ceramic and the second CTE of the PCB can create a bending force **225** that can bend (i.e., flex) the photomultiplier **200**. This flexing can cause a crack (or cracks) in the carrier **210**, a crack (or cracks) in the pixel array circuit **100**, or a crack (or cracks) in the carrier **210** and the pixel array circuit **100**. In other words, bowing (i.e., bending) of the PCB/package/die can result in cracking of the silicon die if one long die/package is used.

(18) The pixel array circuit **100** may include an array of pixels that is aligned along a longer dimension of the pixel array circuit **100** and a shorter dimension transverse to the longer dimension. Likewise, the carrier **210** may have a corresponding longer dimension and a shorter dimension. The longer dimension and shorter dimension may be aligned with a plane **221** defined by the carrier **210**. The bending force **225** on the PCB **220** can flex the carrier **210** so that it is deflected from the plane **221**.

(19) A crack **230** in the photomultiplier **200** can cause an electrical malfunction by breaking a circuit connection or can cause a mechanical or optical malfunction by changing a shape or response of the photomultiplier **200**. The crack **230** may include any fissure, break, or void in a material that should otherwise be intact. Cracking due to the bending force **225** may be more likely when a solder ball density **235** is high (e.g., solder ball pitch 1 mm) and/or when a length **240** of the pixel array circuit **100** is long (e.g., 30 mm).

(20) The present disclosure describes an optoelectronic package that is modular so that a long (and narrow) package can be created as a sequence of modules. In particular, the disclosed carrier may include a plurality of substrate modules bonded end-to-end in a sequence. The bond may be made using a flexible adhesive (e.g., flexible epoxy) so that the seams formed between the substrate modules add a flexibility to the carrier. The flexibility can enable the carrier to flex (i.e., bend) without cracking as the PCB **220** is curved along a long axis of the package. In other words, the seams can provide a stress relief to a bending force **225**, as shown in FIG. 2.

(21) FIG. 3 is a top view of a substrate module **300** according to a possible implementation of the present disclosure. The top view shows a top surface of the substrate module **300**. The top surface corresponds to the shape of the substrate module **300** in any cut plan along the view direction shown. In other words, a bottom surface of the substrate module may be the same size/shape as the top surface of the substrate module. The top surface includes a first rectangular portion **301** (i.e., not hashed portion) and a second rectangular portion **302** (i.e., hashed portion). The first rectangular portion **301** and the second rectangular portion **302** are joined along a length **310** of a side of the first rectangular portion (and the second rectangular portion). In other words, the rectangular portions may be considered offset (i.e., staggered position) by an offset **360** so that a first edge **320** (i.e., left edge) and a second edge **330** (i.e., right edge) are stepped.

(22) As shown in FIG. 3, the first edge **320** may have a step (i.e., first step) from the first rectangular portion **301** to the second rectangular portion **302**, while the second edge **330** may have a step (i.e., second step) from the second rectangular portion **302** to the first rectangular portion **301**. The complementary steps allow a plurality of substrate modules to be arranged in a sequence where the first edge and the second edge interlock. The steps may provide stability and strength to a seam formed between adjacent substrate modules in an array of substrate modules. In other words, the step shape (i.e., step) of the first edge **320** and the second edge **330** may help to reduce a shear force that would otherwise be present at a joint if the step did not exist.

(23) The first rectangular portion **301** may have a first length **351** and a first height **341** and the second rectangular portion **302** may have a second length **352** and a second height **342**. In a possible implementation, the first height **341** may equal the second height **342**. In a possible implementation, the first length **351** may equal the second length **352**. In a possible implementation, the offset **360** may equal one half of the first length **351** and/or the second length **352**. In a possible implementation, the length **310** connecting the rectangular portions may be equal to one half of the first length **351** and/or the second length **352**.

(24) FIG. 4 illustrates a top view of a carrier including pixel array circuits according to a possible

implementation of the present disclosure. The illustration is to aid in a description and the dimensions and relative positions shown are not to scale. As shown in FIG. 4, the carrier 400 includes two substrate modules arranged in an end-to-end sequence, though any number of substrate modules to make the carrier longer or shorter may be possible. The carrier 400 for an optoelectronic package includes a first substrate module 410 and a second substrate module 420. The substrate modules are as shown in FIG. 2 and described above.

(25) The substrate modules are attached at interlocking edges (i.e., stepped edges). The second edge 330 of the first substrate module 410 and the first edge 320 of the second substrate module 420 can be brought into contact to form a seam 430 between the adjacent substrate modules. In a possible implementation, the first substrate module 410 and the second substrate module 420 are mechanically coupled at the seam 430 by a flexible adhesive (e.g., flexible epoxy). The flexible adhesive allows the seam 430 to flex along a direction aligned with the pixels.

(26) Two pixel-array circuits are attached (e.g., bonded) to each substrate module (i.e., at a top surface). The first substrate module 410 has a first pixel-array circuit 411 disposed (e.g., bonded) in a first rectangular portion of the first substrate module and a second pixel array circuit 412 disposed (e.g., bonded) in a second rectangular portion of the first substrate module 410. The second substrate module 420 has a third pixel-array circuit 421 disposed (e.g., bonded) in a first rectangular portion of the second substrate module and a fourth pixel-array circuit 422 disposed (e.g., bonded) in a second rectangular portion of the second substrate module 420.

(27) The pixel array circuits may be arranged similarly (e.g., the same) on each substrate module. The first pixel-array circuit 411 and the second pixel array circuit 412 can be arranged so that they are separated by a gap 440 in a first direction that is transverse to a dimension in line with the pixel array (i.e., array dimension, long dimension). The first pixel-array circuit 411 and the second pixel array circuit 412 may be oriented so that the bond pads face edges (e.g., top and bottom edges, as shown in FIG. 4) of the first substrate module 410 and second substrate module 420, respectively. This arrangement may help to minimize the gap 440 between pixels and may facilitate connecting the pixel array electrically to external circuits. The first pixel-array circuit 411, second pixel array circuit 412, third pixel-array circuit 421, and fourth pixel-array circuit 422 form a pixel array that is approximately linear because the gap 440 dimension may be small (e.g., 200 microns).

(28) The first pixel-array circuit 411 and the second pixel array circuit 412 can be arranged so that they overlap by an overlap 450 in a second direction that is in-line with the array dimension. As mentioned previously, pixels in the overlap region (i.e., overlapping pixels) may be larger than other pixels in order to compensate for the overlap 450. Accordingly, the pixels in each overlap may be larger by an amount corresponding to the overlap 450 so that the overall pixel array length is not shortened by the overlap. The overlap may be made very small (e.g., 100 microns) and may be limited only by a pick and place accuracy and width of the seam.

(29) FIG. 5 illustrates pixel array circuits in a staggered sequence according to an implementation of the present disclosure. The pixel array circuits may be electrically addressed and combined as an array of pixels in a silicon photomultiplier. The array of pixels may have a longer dimension 510 determined by a number of pixels in the array and the overlap between pixel array circuits. The longer dimension 510 may be aligned with a long axis 511 (i.e., horizontal axis) that runs in a direction defined by the pixels in the array. The array of pixels may also have a shorter dimension 520 in a direction along a short axis 521 (i.e., vertical axis), which is transverse to the long axis 511. The sequence (i.e., array) of pixel array circuits may be staggered with respect to the long axis 511. In other words, the pixel array circuits in the array may alternate positions on opposite sides of the long axis 511.

(30) The ratio of the longer dimension 510 to the shorter dimension 520 defines an aspect ratio of the array of pixels, which can correspond to an aspect ratio of the optoelectronic package. The modular optoelectronic package described herein facilitates high aspect ratio (e.g., 2:1) silicon photomultipliers that are robust to thermal cycling. In other words, the array of pixels may be made

long and narrow using the disclosed packaging techniques. FIG. 5 illustrates a 32:1 array of pixels, which can have a longer dimension **510** of approximately 32 mm and a shorter dimension **520** of approximately 5 mm when the pixel dimensions are approximately 1 mm by 1 mm. The actual dimensions of the array and the optoelectronic package may depend on a variety of parameters, such as pixel size, pixel arrangement (e.g., gap, overlap), number of pixels per pixel array circuit, and number of pixel array circuits. An advantage of the present packaging approach is its support for a wide range of possible configurations and dimensions.

(31) FIG. 6A is a top view of a carrier including a plurality of substrate modules according to an implementation of the present disclosure. The carrier includes a first substrate module **410** and a second substrate module **420** arranged in a sequence aligned with a long axis **511**. A seam **430** is formed between the adjacent pair of substrate modules. A region along the carrier that includes the seam **430** may be referred to as a seam region **630**. For simplicity, the pixel array circuits and the circuit substrate of the optoelectronic package are not shown.

(32) FIG. 6B is a side view of the carrier according to an implementation of the present disclosure. The side view is along the long axis **511** of the carrier. As shown, each substrate module of the carrier can include a first sidewall **601** and a second sidewall **602**. The sidewalls may be unitary with the rest of the substrate module or may be attached (e.g., bonded) to the rest of the substrate module during a substrate module fabrication process. The first sidewall **601** may include a first ledge **611** and the second sidewall **602** may include a second ledge **612**. The first ledge **611** and the second ledge **612** are configured to hold a glass lid **620**. The substrate module and the glass lid define a cavity **615**, which can house the pixel-array circuits. The glass lid **620** may be configured to pass light so that the pixels of the pixel-array circuits can detect light after passing through the glass lid. In a possible implementation (not shown), the glass lid may further include an optical element, such as a filter, a lens, or a diffractive optical element (DOE) to filter and/or guide the light as it passes through the window. The glass lid **620** may also provide protection to the pixel-array circuits in the cavity **615** from damage and/or contamination.

(33) A plurality of the glass lids may be bonded to the sidewalls of the carrier to form a window for the pixel array circuits of a silicon photomultiplier. A bond material (e.g., ultra-violet cured epoxy) for the glass lids may be flexible. As shown in FIG. 6A, glass seams **640** are formed between adjacent pairs of glass lids in the window. In a possible implementation, the glass lids are arranged (i.e., along the long axis **511**) so that none of the glass seams **640** are in the seam region **630** of the carrier. In other words, the glass seams between glass lids do not overlap with the carrier seams of the carrier.

(34) The arrangement shown in FIG. 6A may be repeated by adding additional substrate modules and additional glass lids to either the first substrate module **410** or the second substrate module **420**. The offset between the glass seams **640** and the seams of the carrier may help provide strength to the optoelectronic package.

(35) Returning to FIG. 3, the first edge **320** and the second edge **330** of each substrate module **300** may have an additional key feature (i.e., key) on a smaller scale than the step features described previously. In other words, if the step features are considered as a larger key, then the substrate modules may further include a smaller key along each interlocking edge.

(36) FIG. 7 is a top view of a carrier including a seam between edges that includes a key feature according to an implementation of the present disclosure. As shown, a seam **430** is formed between a first substrate module **410** and a second substrate module **420**. A magnified view of the seam **430** is shown in the inset **710**. A second edge **330** of the first substrate module **410** may have a first key feature and a first edge **320** of the second substrate module **420** may have a second key feature that are complementary. The key features may have essentially the same profile (e.g., a comb profile) which may be shifted spatially so that the key features mate with one another. Various profiles may be used to increase a surface area of the seam for bonding and to provide different bond directions to strengthen the seam against shear forces.

(37) For the implementation shown in FIG. 7, the edges include teeth that are configured to interlock when brought together at a seam. Each key feature may have a comb profile that includes a plurality of teeth. The teeth may be regularly spaced and can have a tooth width **711** and a tooth height **712** that provide additional bonding surfaces to strengthen a bond at the seam **430**. In a possible implementation, a tooth width **711** (i.e., $t_{sub.w}$) may be less than or equal to 1 mm (e.g., $0.3\text{ mm} \leq t_{sub.w} \leq 0.5\text{ mm}$). In a possible implementation, a tooth height **712** (i.e., $t_{sub.h}$) may be less than or equal to 3 mm (e.g., $1\text{ mm} \leq t_{sub.h} \leq 2\text{ mm}$).

(38) FIG. 8 is a block diagram of an optical receiver according to an implementation of the present disclosure. The optical receiver **800** includes an optical assembly **810** configured to receive (e.g., focus) light (e.g., in a range from 400 nanometers (nm) to about 800 nm) from a field of view **815**. The optical assembly **810** may include one or more of a filter, a lens (e.g., lenslet array, light guide, compound lens), and a polarizer to process the light for detection by a silicon photomultiplier **820**.

(39) The optical receiver further includes a silicon photomultiplier **820** configured to detect light transmitted to the silicon photomultiplier **820** from the optical assembly **810**. In a possible implementation, the silicon photomultiplier **820** and the optical assembly **810** can be integrated together. For example, a window of the silicon photomultiplier **820** can include a lens. The silicon photomultiplier **820** is configured to convert received light into an electric signal (e.g., voltage or current). A plurality of pixel array circuits, each including a linear array of pixels (e.g., 8 pixels, 12 pixels, 16 pixels, etc.) can be arranged in a sequence to form a high aspect ratio (e.g., 2:1) pixel array. The field of view **815** of the optical receiver may have a shape (e.g., aspect ratio) that corresponds with the high aspect ratio pixel array.

(40) The silicon photon multiple may be packaged in a modular optoelectronic package that has enough flexibility to accommodate flexing due to thermal cycles without damage to the circuitry and/or package. The optoelectronic package (i.e., package) includes a circuit substrate having a longer dimension aligned with a long axis and a shorter dimension aligned with a short axis. The package further includes a carrier fixedly coupled (e.g., soldered) to the circuit substrate (e.g., via a ball grid array). The carrier includes a plurality of substrate modules arranged in a sequence aligned with the long axis. Seams are formed between adjacent pairs of the substrate modules so that the carrier (and pixel array circuits) can flex as the circuit substrate is curved (i.e., bended) along the long axis. The package further includes a window including a plurality of glass lids that are bonded to sidewalls of the carrier in a (continuous) sequence. The glass seams of the window are arranged so that they do not overlap with the seams of the carrier.

(41) The circuit substrate may include circuitry to process the electrical signals from the silicon photomultiplier **820**. For example, the optical receiver may include a processor **830** to convert the signals into information (e.g., an image) and input/output circuitry **840** to communicate the information with other systems. In a possible implementation the optical receiver **800** is part of a light detection and ranging (LIDAR) system. The lidar system may be implemented in a vehicle platform, such as a passenger vehicle.

(42) In the specification and/or figures, typical embodiments have been disclosed. The present disclosure is not limited to such exemplary embodiments. For example, while approximately linear arrays (i.e., one row of pixels) have been discussed, the techniques described herein may be applied to two-dimensional (2D) arrays of pixels (i.e., more than one row of pixels).

(43) Unless defined otherwise, all technical and scientific terms used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art. Methods and materials similar or equivalent to those described herein can be used in the practice or testing of the present disclosure. As used in the specification, and in the appended claims, the singular forms “a,” “an,” “the” include plural referents unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. The term “comprising” and variations thereof as used herein is used synonymously with the term “including” and variations thereof and are open, non-limiting terms. The terms “optional” or “optionally” used herein mean that the subsequently described feature, event or circumstance may or may not occur, and that the

description includes instances where said feature, event or circumstance occurs and instances where it does not. Ranges may be expressed herein as from “about” one particular value, and/or to “about” another particular value. When such a range is expressed, an aspect includes from the one particular value and/or to the other particular value. Similarly, when values are expressed as approximations, by use of the antecedent “about,” it will be understood that the particular value forms another aspect. It will be further understood that the endpoints of each of the ranges are significant both in relation to the other endpoint, and independently of the other endpoint.

(44) Some implementations may be implemented using various semiconductor processing and/or packaging techniques. Some implementations may be implemented using various types of semiconductor processing techniques associated with semiconductor substrates including, but not limited to, for example, Silicon (Si), Gallium Arsenide (GaAs), Gallium Nitride (GaN), Silicon Carbide (SiC) and/or so forth.

(45) While certain features of the described implementations have been illustrated as described herein, many modifications, substitutions, changes and equivalents will now occur to those skilled in the art. It is, therefore, to be understood that the appended claims are intended to cover all such modifications and changes as fall within the scope of the implementations. It should be understood that they have been presented by way of example only, not limitation, and various changes in form and details may be made. Any portion of the apparatus and/or methods described herein may be combined in any combination, except mutually exclusive combinations. The implementations described herein can include various combinations and/or sub-combinations of the functions, components and/or features of the different implementations described.

(46) It will be understood that, in the foregoing description, when an element is referred to as being on, connected to, electrically connected to, coupled to, or electrically coupled to another element, it may be directly on, connected or coupled to the other element, or one or more intervening elements may be present. In contrast, when an element is referred to as being directly on, directly connected to or directly coupled to another element, there are no intervening elements present. Although the terms directly on, directly connected to, or directly coupled to may not be used throughout the detailed description, elements that are shown as being directly on, directly connected or directly coupled can be referred to as such. The claims of the application, if any, may be amended to recite exemplary relationships described in the specification or shown in the figures.

(47) As used in this specification, a singular form may, unless definitely indicating a particular case in terms of the context, include a plural form. Spatially relative terms (e.g., over, above, upper, under, beneath, below, lower, and so forth) are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. In some implementations, the relative terms above and below can, respectively, include vertically above and vertically below. In some implementations, the term adjacent can include laterally adjacent to or horizontally adjacent to.

Claims

1. An optoelectronic package comprising: a circuit substrate having a longer dimension aligned with a long axis and a shorter dimension aligned with a short axis; and a carrier fixedly coupled to the circuit substrate, the carrier including a plurality of substrate modules coupled together at seams between pairs of substrate modules with flexible adhesive so that the plurality of substrate modules are arranged in a sequence aligned with the long axis, the plurality of substrate modules each being a monolithic structure including a first rectangular portion spatially offset from a second rectangular portion to define a step edge at the seams.

2. The optoelectronic package according to claim 1, wherein: the substrate modules are a ceramic material having a first coefficient of thermal expansion and the circuit substrate is a glass-reinforced epoxy laminate material having a second coefficient of thermal expansion; and the

circuit substrate is curved along the long axis due to a difference between the first coefficient of thermal expansion and the second coefficient of thermal expansion during a thermal cycle.

3. The optoelectronic package according to claim 2, wherein the thermal cycle is in a range from -55 degrees Celsius to +150 degrees Celsius.

4. The optoelectronic package according to claim 1, wherein an aspect ratio of the longer dimension to the shorter dimension is greater than or equal to 2 to 1.

5. The optoelectronic package according to claim 1, wherein the sequence is a first sequence and the optoelectronic package further includes: a plurality of pixel array circuits bonded to the carrier in a second sequence that is staggered with respect to a direction aligned with the long axis.

6. The optoelectronic package according to claim 5, wherein the direction aligned with the long axis is a first direction and: adjacent pairs of the plurality of pixel array circuits are separated by a gap in a second direction aligned with the short axis and overlap by an overlap in the direction aligned with the long axis.

7. The optoelectronic package according to claim 5, wherein two pixel array circuits are coupled to each substrate module in the sequence.

8. The optoelectronic package according to claim 5, wherein a first pixel array circuit of a pair of pixel array circuits is bonded to the first rectangular portion and a second pixel array circuit of the pair of pixel array circuits is bonded to the second rectangular portion.

9. The optoelectronic package according to claim 1, wherein each of the plurality of substrate modules has a first edge configured to couple to a previous substrate module in the sequence and a second edge configured to couple with a subsequent substrate module in the sequence, the first edge having a first key feature and the second edge having a second key feature, the first key feature and the second key feature having teeth, the teeth configured to interlock when brought together at a seam.

10. A silicon photomultiplier comprising: a circuit substrate having a longer dimension and a shorter dimension aligned within a plane; a carrier fixedly coupled to the circuit substrate, the carrier including a plurality of substrate modules, each substrate module being a monolithic structure including a first rectangular portion spatially offset from a second rectangular portion to define a step edge, the plurality of substrate modules arranged in a sequence aligned with the longer dimension wherein seams are formed at the step edge between adjacent pairs of substrate modules in the sequence so that the carrier flexes in response to the circuit substrate being deflected from the plane; a window including a plurality of transparent lids that bonded to sidewalls of the carrier in a sequence of transparent lids, wherein seams are formed between adjacent pairs of transparent lids in the sequence of transparent lids; and a plurality of pixel array circuits bonded to the carrier in a sequence that is staggered with respect to a direction aligned with the longer dimension, the silicon photomultiplier configured to detect light through the window.

11. The silicon photomultiplier according to claim 10, wherein the light is a light detection and ranging (LIDAR) signal.

12. The silicon photomultiplier according to claim 10, wherein: the substrate modules are a ceramic material having a first coefficient of thermal expansion and the circuit substrate is a glass-reinforced epoxy laminate material having a second coefficient of thermal expansion; and the circuit substrate is deflected from the plane due to a difference between the first coefficient of thermal expansion and the second coefficient of thermal expansion during a thermal cycle.

13. The silicon photomultiplier according to claim 12, wherein the thermal cycle is in a range from -55 degrees Celsius to +150 degrees Celsius.

14. The silicon photomultiplier according to claim 10, wherein an aspect ratio of the longer dimension to the shorter dimension is greater than or equal to 2 to 1.

15. The silicon photomultiplier according to claim 10, wherein: adjacent pairs of the plurality of pixel array circuits are separated by a gap in a direction aligned with the shorter dimension and overlap by an overlap in the direction aligned with the longer dimension.

16. The silicon photomultiplier according to claim 10, wherein the silicon photomultiplier includes at least two pixel array circuits in the sequence.
17. The silicon photomultiplier according to claim 10, wherein: the plurality of pixel array circuits are bonded to each substrate module in pairs, each pair including a first pixel array circuit and a second pixel array circuit; and the first pixel array circuit is bonded to the first rectangular portion and the second pixel array circuit is bonded to the second rectangular portion.
18. The silicon photomultiplier according to claim 10, wherein each of the plurality of substrate modules has a first edge configured to couple to a previous substrate module in the sequence and a second edge configured to couple with a subsequent substrate module in the sequence, the first edge having a first key feature and the second edge having a second key feature, the first key feature and the second key feature having teeth configured to interlock when brought together at a seam.
19. An optical receiver including: an optical assembly configured to focus light from a field of view; and a silicon photomultiplier including: a printed circuit board having a longer dimension aligned with a long axis and a shorter dimension aligned with a short axis; a carrier soldered to the printed circuit board, the carrier including a plurality of substrate modules, each substrate module being a monolithic structure including a first rectangular portion spatially offset from a second rectangular portion, the plurality of substrate modules arranged in a sequence aligned with the long axis wherein adjacent pairs of substrate modules in the sequence are bonded at a seam with a flexible adhesive so that the carrier can flex as the printed circuit board is curved along the long axis; a window including a plurality of glass lids that bonded to sidewalls of the carrier in a sequence, wherein glass seams are formed between adjacent pairs of glass lids in the sequence; and a plurality of pixel array circuits bonded to the carrier in a sequence that is staggered with respect to a direction aligned with the long axis, the silicon photomultiplier configured to detect the light from the field of view through the window.
20. The optical receiver according to claim 19, wherein the glass seams of the window do not overlap with seams of the carrier.
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